

Open Source Automation Tools *to* Make Your Home Smart

In a smart home, the controlled objects are typically connected to a hub, which may be a wall-mounted unit, a tablet or even a smartphone.

This article lists nine open source home automation tools you can choose from to make your home smart.



Automating your home has become a rather complex task with the ever expanding number of devices available to automatically protect and monitor your home. There are many open source devices to control window shutters, doors, fans, lights, air conditioners, microwave ovens, etc, in the market. On the one hand, you may want to protect your home from theft, fire or other threats, while on the other, you may be interested in reducing your energy usage, for which there are countless devices available. Home automation can include the scheduling and automatic operation of lighting, heating, air conditioning, window shutters, security systems and more.

The possibilities in home automation are many and enable you to build wireless networks, automate all consumer electronics devices at home, monitor pets when you are away, set up an answering system, create a weather station, etc. All of this involves integrating many different home automation technologies into one.

Home automation systems work on their own protocols, which are specific to the company that developed the system. Software companies may favour such an approach as it ties customers to their products only. It is therefore important to evaluate a home automation system to ensure that it is built on open protocols. Such open solutions are released under an open source licence.